CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE UPDATE



PRESENTED BY QUINN PEOPLES

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RECENT BACKGROUND



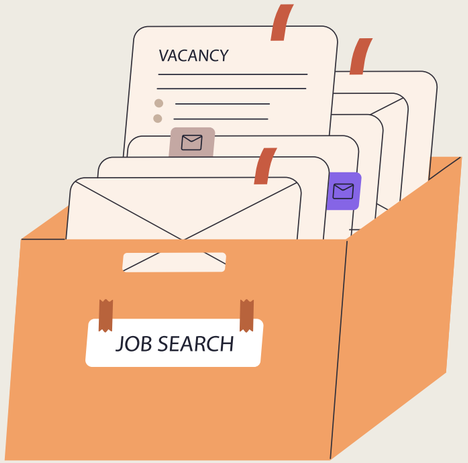
FALL 2022 - SPRING 2023

- 150 meetings with community to co-designed vision for the Center for Black Student Excellence
- Community “pause and reset”



SUMMER 2023 -2024

- Investigation of sites that emerged from the community “pause and reset” workshop series



FALL 2024 - WINTER 2024

- Hired the Director of Center for Black Student Excellence and Project Manager
- Began Coalition Building

PRIORITIES

The CBSE staff collaboratively developed a community coalition strategy aligned with the CBSE vision. This collaborative effort involved extensive engagement and deliberation over several months.

To personalize student outcomes, a series of collective community conversations were facilitated, and will continue to be facilitated, with Principals from Harriet Tubman Middle School and Boise Eliot-Humboldt Elementary. These discussions aimed to understand the unique needs and aspirations of students within each school community.

The development of multi-sector partnerships was guided by principles of academic research, innovation, and liberatory design. This approach prioritized the expansion of capacity, power, and resources within the community to collectively implement strategies that advance educational equity especially for Black students within the PPS district.

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CBSE 4 CORE



PROJECT ONE - Action 4 Equity (A4E)

The A4E Framework assists schools in identifying trusted adults, improve student belonging and achievement, increase attendance, support leadership development, and expand access within public education systems using:

- Equity Leader/Trusted Adult
- A4E Cards

A4E will serve as the foundation for our other three initiatives to make up "The Four Core Initiatives," that align with the vision for the Center for Black Student Excellence. Those initiatives are:

- ***Pages of Possibility (POP)***
- ***Bridges to Brilliance (B2B)***
- ***Parents Advocating for Student Success (PASS)***

The Four Core Initiatives will involve a collaborative effort between the CBSE, PPS departments, and non-profit organizations to implement and measure the effectiveness of evidence-based academic pilot programs within a Multi-Tiered System of Supports (MTSS) framework.

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PROJECT TWO - POP, PASS, and B2B

Pages of Possibility (POP): In harmony with Superintendent Armstrong's Advancing Literacy campaign, cultivates a love of reading by providing each student with a personalized library of twelve culturally relevant books.

Parents Advocating for Student Success (PASS): This initiative establishes robust partnerships with parents and guardians to create a supportive community that enhances student well-being and academic achievement. By fostering strong connections, PASS empowers parents and equips them with the tools and resources necessary to advocate effectively for their children's educational needs.

Bridges 2 Brilliance (B2B): A mentoring/tutoring program addresses educational disparities and empowers the next generation of leaders by fostering intergenerational knowledge transfer and skill development through facilitated dialogues and mentorship opportunities.

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MEASURING IMPACT





Quantitative Measures:

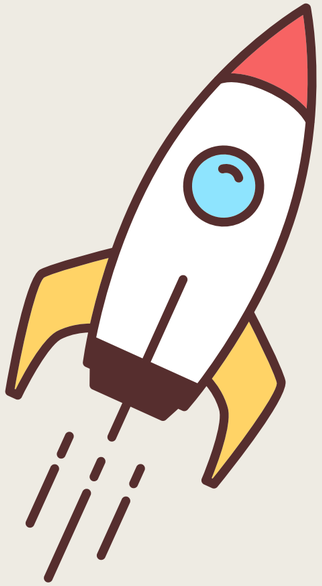
- School Climate and Culture:
  - Increased student and staff satisfaction with school climate surveys
  - Decreased disciplinary incidents
  - Improved school culture scores on external assessments
- Student Achievement and Engagement:
  - Increased student achievement on standardized tests
  - Improved attendance rates
  - Increased student participation in extracurricular activities

Qualitative Measures:

- Student Portfolios:
  - Collect student work samples (e.g., essays, projects, presentations) to demonstrate growth in critical thinking, problem-solving, and creativity.
  - Focus Groups: Conduct focus groups with students, staff, and parents to gather in-depth feedback on school climate and identify areas for improvement.

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4 CORE NEXT STEPS



FEBRUARY 2025

- Soft launch of Action 4 Equity at 2 schools sites in Albina with community support.



MARCH - JUNE 2025

- Implement and manage A4E initiative, begin to determine timelines for other initiatives based on needs, and engage with community.



SUMMER 2025

- Train A4E trusted adults for full launch in Fall and taking steps toward acquiring a space.

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FINDING A HOME

Guided by community vision, The CBSE staff is working tirelessly to find a home for the Center for Black Student Excellence. In reflecting that vision, PPS staff, community partners, and data regarding the desired student outcomes, has supported us in envisioning a space that includes the following:

The CREATE & INNOVATE Lab

A dedicated pedagogical environment for students to engage in experiential learning within the entrepreneurial, mechanical, and creative industries.

The Center for Culture and Community Collaboration

A centralized space for students to engage in intercultural understanding and appreciation of history & culture within the Portland Public School community.

The Center for Wellness and Excellence in Learning

A holistic approach to supporting Black students, families, and educators. By centering the needs and experiences of these individuals, and welcoming and affirming all visitors regardless of background or identity, the Center will prioritize healing justice, addressing historical trauma, and promoting collective liberation.

The Multi-Purpose Center

These flexible spaces that are designed to empower student engagement, community building, and diverse learning experiences through a wide range of activities.



LET'S CREATE BRIGHTER FUTURES TOGETHER



WHAT QUESTIONS DO YOU HAVE?

FOR MORE INFORMATION, REACH OUT TO US AT CBSE@PPS.NET